

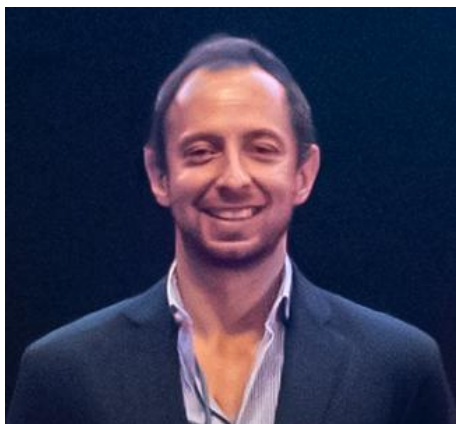
Profiles of Speakers



Qiang Hu 胡强

Chair Professor and Head, Department of Engineering Biology, Faculty of Synthetic Biology, Shenzhen University of Advanced Technology (SUAT) (Shenzhen, China)

Dr. Qiang Hu is a Chair Professor and Head of Department of Engineering Biology, Faculty of Synthetic Biology, Shenzhen University of Advanced Technology, Shenzhen, China. He also is an Adjunct Professor in the Institute of Synthetic Biology, Shenzhen Institutes of Advanced Technology, Chinese Academy of Sciences. Prior to these positions, Dr. Hu was Professor and co-Director of the Laboratory for Algae Research and Biotechnology and co-Director of the Arizona Center for Algae Technology and Innovation at Arizona State University. He has over 40 years of experience in fundamental and applied research on algae on topics ranging from photosynthesis, biosynthesis of lipids and carotenoids, growth physiology of high-density algal culture, photobioreactor system design, and applications of algal mass culture technology for biofuels and chemicals, and for environmental bioremediation. He was the President (2021-2024) and outgoing President (2025-2027) of International Society for Applied Phycology. Currently, he is an Associate Editor of *Algae* and an editorial board member of *Journal of Applied Phycology*, *Applied Phycology* and *Phycology*.

**Miguel Pombo****Founder - Azores Life Science / Ignae (Azores, Portugal)**

Having graduated from Nova University in Lisbon, Miguel has worked in public and regulatory affairs for international clients in the fields of food, cosmetics, pharma, communications and airline companies. He founded Azores Life Science in 2012, the parent company of Ignae, a skincare brand available in many prestigious retailers around the world. Azores Life Science uses AI and genomics to identify extremophilic microorganisms from Azores Islands and their application in pharma, food, cosmetics and industrial processes.



Pedro A. Lima

President of the Board, CEO, CSO and co-founder - Sea4US (Lisbon, Portugal)

Professor, Nova Medical School - Universidade NOVA de Lisboa (Lisbon, Portugal)

CEO and co-founder of Sea4Us where, he also leads the Research & Development area. Pedro is also a Professor in the Nova Medical School in Lisbon. During his +9 years in Sea4Us, he dedicated all his drive to Tech transfer. His goal is to revolutionise Pain Management, aligned with a coherent creation of economic value. At Sea4Us, he placed his two main core expertise and areas of knowledge into a differentiating concept. Those areas are Neurosciences (biophysics and Pharmacology of Ion-channels) and Marine Biology. In Marine life lies an immense diversity of compounds that represent a true 'new chemistry' to be explored for differentiating medications. This is more than a strong belief; it is also an exciting business model.



James Chang

Managing Director - Geb Impact Technology (Hong Kong, China)

I was born and raised in Hong Kong and moved to the U.S. after earning my undergraduate degree from the University of Washington. With more than thirty years of experience in the semiconductor industry, I ultimately served as the Worldwide Sales Director for Polysilicon Material at MEMC.

In 2013, I returned to Hong Kong and established Geb Impact Technology, where I concentrate on sustainable microalgae applications. Furthermore, I hold both an MSc and an MBA, demonstrating my dedication to integrating business knowledge with environmental sustainability throughout my career.

<Photo to be provided>

Speaker TBC
(China)

<Biography to be provided>



Yu Rencheng 于仁成

Professor - Institute of Oceanology, Chinese Academy of Sciences (IOCAS) (Qingdao, China)

Yu Rencheng is a researcher at the Institute of Oceanology, Chinese Academy of Sciences (IOCAS), and currently serves as a distinguished researcher at CAS, as well as a Professor at the University of Chinese Academy of Sciences. He also holds important roles in the EASTHAB Scientific Advisory Committee, WESTPAC Harmful Algal Blooms Working Group, Water Environment Division of the Chinese Society of Oceanology and Limnology, and the Chinese Society of Oceanology.

His main research areas include the processes and mechanisms of coastal ecosystem evolution, methods for analyzing and detecting toxic and harmful algae and algal toxins, ecological and oceanographic mechanisms behind the formation and evolution of harmful algal blooms, as well as the harmful effects of these blooms and ecological safety studies.

In the past five years, he has led more than 10 national-level projects and published over 200 papers in academic journals domestically and internationally. He has also contributed to the compilation of several monographs. On the international collaboration front, he participated in the establishment of the China-Portugal STARLab and the Sino-Portugal Joint Lab for Marine and Environmental Sciences, through which he developed solid cooperative relationships with renowned research institutions in countries such as Portugal, France, and Australia.



Wen-Jun Li 李文均

Distinguished Professor, School of Life Sciences - Sun Yat-Sen University (Guangzhou, China)

Wen-Jun Li received his PhD in Microbiology from Shenyang Institute of Applied Ecology, Chinese Academy of Sciences in 2002. He is currently working as Distinguished Professor in School of Life Sciences, Sun Yat-Sen University, Guangzhou, China. His publications include 10 monographs, 30 authorized patents, and more than 700 peer reviewed papers (<https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Wen-Jun-Li>) as the first or corresponding authors. His research mainly focuses on microbial diversity under those unusual environments (including marine, salt lake, desert and hot spring ecosystems) by using culture-dependent and culture-independent methods, and also on microbial ecology and evolution. He was awarded the WFCC (The World Federation for Culture Collections) Skerman award for microbial taxonomy, and other 10 leading awards for his outstanding research contributions on the field of microbial systematics and microbial ecology.

He is serving as editorial board members or Associate Editors of more than 10 International journals, and he was appointed as membership of International Committee on Systematics of Prokaryotes (ICSP) since 2017, and President of Bergey's International Society for Microbial Systematics (BISMiS, <https://www.bismis.net/bismislive.html>) since December of 2023.



Wei Yu 俞威

CEO and Founder - Xiaozao Tech/Lyxia 小藻科技(安吉)有限公司 (Shenzhen, China)

Wei Yu is the founder of Lyxia/Xiaozao Tech, a biotechnology company he established in 2012. For the past 12 years, Wei has dedicated his career to advancing microalgae-based technologies. He holds a Ph.D. in Biomedical Engineering from UCLA and a Bachelor's degree in Biomedical Engineering from Zhejiang University.

Xiaozao Tech specializes in the innovation, cultivation, and processing of microalgae-derived specialty ingredients. Utilising its proprietary Phototrophic cellular platform, the company harnesses the potential of *Nannochloropsis*- a single-cell green algae - to produce high-value bioactive components on a commercial scale. These components include polar lipids, EPA (eicosapentaenoic acid), polysaccharides, proteins/peptides, and more, offering sustainable and innovative solutions for various industries.



Helena Abreu

President - International Seaweed Association (Aveiro, Portugal)

Helena Abreu is a marine biologist with over 20 years of expertise in seaweed, integrating scientific research, entrepreneurship, and sustainability. Her career began in the Azores, focusing on taxonomy and ecology, but a passion for seaweed aquaculture led her to explore Integrated Multi-Trophic Aquaculture (IMTA). During her Ph.D. and research career across Portugal, the USA, Chile, and Ireland, she developed expertise in seaweed cultivation systems, species diversity, and biomass applications.

In 2011, Helena co-founded ALGAplus, pioneering organic-certified IMTA seaweed farming in Europe. Under her leadership, the company became a market leader, securing funding, expanding market networks, and driving industry awareness. After leaving ALGAplus in early 2024, she transitioned to independent consulting, advising on innovation, business development, and international collaborations in the seaweed sector.

Beyond her consulting work, Helena contributes to global seaweed initiatives as President of the International Seaweed Association (ISA, 2023-2025) and Strategic Advisor to the Global Seaweed Coalition. She actively fosters knowledge exchange, industry collaboration, and sustainable development in alignment with global sustainability goals.

A strong advocate for community impact, Helena has supervised over 30 graduate and postgraduate students, published extensively on seaweed ecology, cultivation, and applications, and is a sought-after speaker at international conferences. Her mission is to advance sustainable marine resource management, connect stakeholders across the seaweed value chain, and ensure that marine resources are valued and utilized responsibly for future generations.

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/helena-abreu-seaweed>

<https://orcid.org/0000-0002-7630-3185>



Jorge Dias

Co-founder and CEO - SPAROS Lda. (Olhão, Portugal)

Jorge Dias is the Co-founder and CEO of SPAROS LDA (www.sparos.pt), a science and technology driven company dedicated to the development and testing of new products and tailored nutritional solutions for the aquaculture market. He holds a PhD in Biomedical Sciences (specialty Nutrition) by the University of Bordeaux I (France) and University of Porto (Portugal), and an MSc in Food Technology by the University of Bordeaux I (France). Prior to founding SPAROS, he was a scientist at DSM Nutritional Products. He has authored 4 book chapters and more than 100 peer-review papers on the topic of fish nutrition. His expertise covers the areas of nutritional requirements of fish and shrimp; feed formulation; extrusion technology; and the practical development of additives and functional raw materials in aquaculture feeds.



Shi Yanxi 时彦祎

Founder - Zhuhai Biori Biotechnology Co., Ltd. (Zhuhai, China)

Mr. Shi Yanxi is the founder of Zhuhai Biori Biotechnology Co., Ltd. Focusing on the upstream core raw materials sector of bio-manufacturing, Zhuhai Biori Biotechnology Co., Ltd. is a national high-tech enterprise, a specialized, refined, unique, and innovative "little giant" enterprise, and the Guangdong Molecular Diagnostic Enzyme Engineering Technology Research Center. Biori Biotech has established several technological platforms including enzyme evolution and screening, aptamer screening, antibody development, gene engineering expression, protein process development, and raw material application development. In the fields of fluorescence quantitative PCR, isothermal amplification, freeze-dried reagents for molecular diagnostics, it has launched a full range of high-performance enzyme raw materials and premix products that can provide comprehensive technical solutions for molecular diagnostic reagent manufacturers. Additionally, Biori Biotech continuously expands in the biomedicine field, with mRNA vaccine enzyme raw materials and biopharmaceutical process residue detection reagents gaining recognition and cooperation from numerous well-known enterprises.

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Speaker TBC
(China)

<Biography to be provided>



Pedro Rodrigues

Vice-Dean for Lifelong Learning and Partnerships of the Faculty of Biotechnology - Universidade Católica Portuguesa (ESB-UCP) (Porto, Portugal)

Pedro Miguel Rodrigues (B.Sc., M.Sc., and Ph.D. in Biomedical Engineering) is a Professor and the Vice-Dean for Lifelong Learning and Partnerships of the Faculty of Biotechnology - Universidade Católica Portuguesa (ESB-UCP). He is also an integrated member of the Centre for Biotechnology and Fine Chemistry of UCP (CBQF-UCP), Porto, Portugal. He is the coordinator of the postgraduate course in Data Science in Biotechnology and Co-coordinator of the Bioengineering degree at ESB-UCP. He is responsible for Curricular Units of signal and image processing, computer programming, artificial intelligence, and machine learning. He has published more than 90 articles in international peer-reviewed scientific journals, book chapters, and conference articles on the interface between Artificial Intelligence and Medicine. He holds a technological patent that analyzes EEG signals via AI algorithms for asymptomatic or early diagnosis of Alzheimer's disease. His research areas focus on digital signal processing and artificial intelligence applied to diagnose neurodegenerative, cardiac, and speech diseases and on the development of biosensors, electronic instrumentation tools, microcontrollers, and smart tools for fast controlling and monitoring sustainable living cities & spaces and agri-food & biological/biomedical systems.



Wang Yong 王勇

Professor - Tsinghua Shenzhen International Graduate School; Shenzhen Blue Ocean Deep Sea Equipment Technology co., Ltd (Shenzhen, China)

I received my PhD from the University of Hong Kong and postdoc training in King Abdullah University of Science and Technology. Before joining in Tsinghua University, I have been working in Institute of Deep-Sea Science and Engineering of Chinese Academy of Sciences between 2013 and 2022. I am the leading scientist in invention of automatic deep-sea sampling and detection techniques for deep-sea microbial research in China. I have published over 120 peer-reviewed articles and book chapters, which have been cited over 7500 times. Some of the articles were published in Nature Comm, ISME J., Nucleic Acids Res., The Innovation and Sci. Bull. I obtained National Natural Science Award, "Ten-Thousand Talents" programme, Young Talent Award of National Science and Technology Department, and Excellence Award of "One-Hundred Talents" programme of CAS. I am serving as associate editors of several journals, and leading an international twilight zone ecosystem research project (TOWER) under UN Decade 2021-2030 programme.



Simon Ming Yuen LEE

Chair Professor of Biomedical Sciences in Department of Food Science and Nutrition, and Director of PolyU-BGI Joint Research Centre for Genomics and Synthetic Biology in Global Ocean Resources – The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (Hong Kong, China)

Simon Ming Yuen LEE is currently Chair Professor of Biomedical Sciences in Department of Food Science and Nutrition, and Director of PolyU-BGI Joint Research Centre for Genomics and Synthetic Biology in Global Ocean Resources, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University. Simon obtained PhD degree in biochemistry from The Chinese University of Hong Kong. His research interest lies in the discovery of drug-like agents from natural products including small molecules and biologics for use in various therapeutic areas, including brain disorder and neurodegenerative diseases. His dedication to education and research in the fields of omics, pharmacology and toxicology has led to over 360 scholarly articles, including Nature, Nature Genetics, Nature Communications (4×) and Science Advances. Simon is in Stanford university's list of top 2% of most-cited scientists in Pharmaceutical Science and Biology (with h-index: 65 from Scopus). Simon is a life member of Clare Hall, University of Cambridge. He has served as an editorial board member for numerous international journals including Chinese Medicine, Antioxidants, Journal of Ethopharmacology, and Water Biology and Security.



Pedro M. Pousão Ferreira

Researcher, President of the Scientific Council, Head of Estação Piloto de Piscicultura de Olhão (EPPO) - Instituto Português do Mar e da Atmosfera (Portugal)

Pedro Pousão-Ferreira is a biologist, Principal Researcher with Habilitation and expertise in aquaculture in IPMA. He is responsible for the Aquaculture Research Station in Olhão. He has more than 40 years' experience in the reproduction (hatchery), larval rearing, nutrition, ongrowing and production of bass, sole, meagre, grouper and 6 species of breams on in-shore (earth ponds) and on offshore (cages). He has participated in 1/6 national and international research projects. Member of Scientific Review Panel of Agência Nacional de Inovação (ANI) and Fundação para a Ciência e Tecnologia (FCT). Member of External Scientific Review Panel (ESRP) of AKDN (Aga Khan foundation).

He has 221 papers in international scientific periodicals with referees, 34 peer-reviewed short papers, 547 communication/posters in scientific meetings and workshops, 4 manuals, 6 book chapters and 1 technical book. Is also Professor of Aquaculture at the University of Porto (ICBAS) and was Professor of marine larviculture and aquaculture at the University of Algarve (2011-2013). Presently is also President of the Scientific Council of IPMA and former President of Forum of Scientific Council of State Laboratories (Jun.2020- Dec.2021).

President of the Board of S2AQUA - Collaborative Laboratory for a Sustainable and Intelligent Aquaculture.

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<http://www.researcherid.com/rid/H-3689-2014>

Scopus Author ID: 6506349877

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<http://orcid.org/0000-0001-6746-764X>

Google Scholar

https://scholar.google.pt/citations?hl=pt-PT&user=YhU_bjAAAAAJ&view_op=list_works

<Photo to be provided>

Angela Kam

Macau International Carbon Emission Exchange (Macau, China)

<Biography to be provided>



Chan Yi Ngok 陳一謬

Director - Pudong-Hong Kong Institute for Technology Transfer and Innovation (Hong Kong, China)

Executive Vice Chairman - Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area Biotechnology Alliance (Hong Kong, China)

Mr. Chan Yi Ngok currently serves as the Chief Executive Officer of a Hong Kong-based health technology company and holds leadership positions in several prominent biotechnology industry associations in Hong Kong. He has overseen the organization of major events including BIOHK2022-2025 and the 3rd Conference of Global Health Forum of the Boao Forum for Asia in 2024. Additionally, he is the founding director of the Pudong-Hongkong Institute for Technology Transfer and Innovation, a joint initiative between Hong Kong Biotechnology Organization and Shanghai Pudong Development (Group) Co., Ltd.

Beyond his biotech engagements, Mr. Chan is a managing director of an investment fund under a full licensed financial group regulated by the Securities and Futures Commission of Hong Kong. He collaborates with renowned industrial park developers in Beijing on the management of technology projects in the Chinese mainland. Prior to his enterprising ventures, Mr. Chan was a partner of a 4As advertising agency in Singapore steering the business development of the ASEAN market, and worked at a British multinational bank providing corporate financing solutions to ultra-high-net-worth individuals in real estate development and investment sectors.

Mr. Chan holds a first class honours degree from the University of Hong Kong, along with advanced degrees from Peking University and the University of Oxford.



Benedita Chaves

Director of Innovation and R&D Department - LIPOR (Porto, Portugal)

Director of Innovation and R&D Department at LIPOR - a waste management company in the Porto Region (Portugal).

Senior Environmental Engineer, with experience in Strategy, Execution, Sustainability, Innovation Management and Sustainable Product Development.

Implementing a business model change, focusing on new products based on municipal waste.

She likes to get things done and to create added value including for the environment and the community, while making a better place out of the world.



André Antunes

Acting Dean of Institute of Science and Environment - University of Saint Joseph (Macau, China)

André Antunes is an Associate Professor at Institute of Science and Environment of the University of Saint Joseph. He is an expert in microbiology of marine and extreme environments, having specialized in deep-sea and high salinity locations.

He has done his undergraduate studies in Biology at the University of Coimbra (Portugal), followed with a PhD in Biochemistry (Microbiology) at the same institution but with his PhD research work being conducted at the prestigious Lehrstuhl für Mikrobiologie und Archaeenzentrum of the University of Regensburg (Germany). His research career has included periods of work in several countries in Europe, as well as in Africa, and in the Middle East. Before his current appointment he had previous faculty positions in Cabo Verde, in the UK, and at the State Key Laboratory of Lunar and Planetary Sciences at Macau University of Science and Technology (MUST), where he was the leader of the Astrobiology Research Group and the coordinator of the Astrobiology and Cosmochemistry Experimental Platforms.

He has extensive experience with international collaborations, having participated as PI and team member of several research projects across the globe and having joined and lead several research expeditions and cruises. As part of these, he previously worked as project manager, being involved in the national and European coordination of the ESFRI EU-funded project MIRRI (Microbial Resource Research Infrastructure), as well as being involved with the ESFRI EU-funded project Rltrain (Research Infrastructures Training Programme). He also acted as consultant and invited committee member for NASA, ESA, and the European Science Foundation. Furthermore, he is an elected member of the Communications Committee of the Microbiology Society, Chair of the Ocean Sustainability Advisory Group and Global Ambassador for Applied Microbiology International, and editorial member for a variety of leading journals in his field.

Selected research highlights:

- i) New species and higher-ranked taxa: two new orders, one possible new phylum;
- ii) Novel characteristics relevant for biotechnology and cellular physiology: New cellular contractility cycle; first Halobacteria preferring anaerobiosis; first prokaryotes accumulating glycerol;
- iii) -Omics based analysis: first genomics and proteomics studies in deep-sea brines;
- iv) Bioprospection: New strains with cytotoxic and apoptotic activity; in silico-based exploration for biosynthetic gene clusters; studies in biogenic carbonate production.
- v) New computer-based and experimental tools: Portal for microbial knowledge exploration; data analysis tool for microbial genomes; database on halophilic archaea, as well as an innovative microbial isolation technique).



Maria Manuela Estevez Pintado

Head of CBQF – Centre of Biotechnology and Fine Chemistry – Universidade Católica Portuguesa (Porto, Portugal)

Maria Manuela Estevez Pintado is a Professor of the College of Biotechnology of the Portuguese Catholic University (ESB-UCP) since 2005. In 2017, she became the director of CBQF (Chemistry and Biotechnology Center – State Associate Laboratory), a ESB UCP research unit as well as Associate Director of ESB UCP. She was a member of the Research and Internationalization Group of UCP (2014-2016). She has established strong interaction with industry and she has been Coordinator of Department of Scientific Services for Industry (SETIF) (2013-2016). Additionally, she has been an invited professor at Paraíba Federal University (2012 and from 2014 to 2016).

She has a B.Sc. in Pharmacy from the Faculty of Pharmacy of the University of Porto (1991) and finished her Ph.D. in Biotechnology (in the field of Food Science and Engineering) from the Portuguese Catholic University in 1999. In the same year (until 2002) she obtained a Post-doc research position. She coordinated the Task Force of Dairy Products of the College of Biotechnology Industry Association (AESBUC; 2000-2005).

Her research interests include Biotechnology and Biochemistry - carry out research in a range of key technologies for the production, characterization, and preservation of industrially/traditionally processed products. The research can be summarized into:

- (i) development and compositional characterization and validation of bioactivity of functional ingredients (proteins and biopeptides, antioxidants, probiotics, prebiotics and antimicrobials) and study applications on the development of novel functional foods
- (ii) by-product upgrading through bioprocesses and extraction processes aiming to obtain high-added value products
- (iii) microbiology and biochemistry in food field, including key technologies for the production, characterization, and safety issues of products and
- (iv) application of the above research developments to other Biotechnological fields.



Luís Rochartre Álvares

Senior Advisor - Planetiers New Generation (Lisbon, Portugal)

Luis Rochartre Álvares - Forestry engineer (UTAD), postgraduate in Sustainability at the Stanford Graduate School of Business and Harvard Business School. He is currently Chairman of the Sustainability Committee at Mota-Engil, Senior Advisor at Planetiers New Generation e Novais Law firm, Senior Consultant at Von Rohr & Associates (Geneve), Partner & Head of Sustainability at Unobvious Solutions, Sustainable Transformation Leader at Finitor Consulting, Portugal Local Partner at GlobeScan (Toronto), Business Partner at SFORI, Sustainability Practice Advisor at Epic Talent Society and Sustainability Curator at Spinn.

Visiting Professor at ISEG - Lisbon School of Economics & Management and Industry Fellow at Católica Porto Business School. He also participates in The Natural Step Portugal, Build Up Labs, AGRIFOOD4FUTURE, Zero Emissions World, Help Images, C-Level Mentorship Academy, AGAVI, CITAB/UTAD and Colab Forest Wise.



Deepa Alex Mora

Founder and Managing Director - BioMyne – Biotech Innovation and Engineering Limited (Macau, China)

Deepa Mora is the founder of BioMyne, a Macau-based biotechnology firm pioneering sustainable solutions through advanced resource valorization. With expertise in plant molecular biology and cross-border collaborations, BioMyne bridges scientific innovation and industrial applications—from bioactive compound discovery to eco-material development. Deepa partners with institutions like the University of Macau, MUST, MPU, USJ and Portuguese universities to drive scalable, circular bioeconomy models. Deepa actively promotes circular economy principles, co-organizing the 2024 Biotech Innovation & Sustainability Forum and sharing insights via columns in Macau Business and Hong Kong Examiner.



Débora Campos
Founder & CEO - AgroGrIN Tech (Porto, Portugal)

Doctor Debora holds her PhD in Biotechnology and Food Science, from Portuguese Catholic University (UCP), with over 12 years of experience in biotechnology R&D at green and sustainable technologies. She began her professional career as a fellow researcher at CBQF (Center of Biotechnology and Fine Chemistry), progressing to PhD and later post-doc. While working as a researcher, she started her entrepreneurial career, by launching the AgroGrIN Tech, a startup transferring novel technologies to the industry aiming the efficient upcycling fruit waste and by-products.

She published 47 research/ review articles in refereed international journals and authored 9 chapters in handbooks on these topics, edited 1 book, and is the author 1 granted European patent, has an h-index of 23 and guest editor of several special issues from MDPI, Frontiers and Elsevier. She integrated several R&D projects nationally and internationally, which enable her to be involved in collaborations with multiple Universities and Research Centers, companies and associations/ technology clusters.



Isabel Braga da Cruz
Pro-Rector for Sustainability, UCP Porto (Porto, Portugal)

Isabel Braga da Cruz is currently part of the Universidade Católica Portuguesa (UCP) Rector's team, serving as Pro-Rector, with responsibility for the Porto Regional Centre (since 2017) and the Sustainability at UCP (since 2024). She was the Executive Director (2016-2017) and Executive Coordinator of the Knowledge Division (2010-2016) of PortugalFoods: Portuguese Agri-Food Cluster.

Throughout her career, she has worked extensively with industry in technology transfer, identifying technological and market opportunities, and fostering partnerships between the industrial sector and academia, with the goal of promoting innovation and increasing the technological index and competitiveness of companies.

As an entrepreneur, she was a founding partner of two companies: WEDOTECH (2006-2019) and WEDOECO (2015-2019).

Isabel Braga da Cruz holds a PhD in Biotechnology from UCP, in collaboration with Nestlé Research Centre (Switzerland, 2006); and a Postgraduate degree in Management, COHITEC Programme - "Turning Technologies into Business", (2004) from North Carolina State University and COTEC Portugal. She holds a Master's in Food Science and Engineering (1996), and a Bachelor's degree in Food Engineering (1994) from the Escola Superior de Biotecnologia (ESB/UCP).

Throughout her professional career, she has played an active role with public authorities, business community, and academia, participating as an expert and/or serving on advisory and scientific committees related to the Portuguese agri-food sector and innovation. She is a member of the UCP Board of Trustees and the Financial Management Council. Among others, she is a member of the Advisory Committee of COTEC-Portugal, the Portuguese Development Bank, the Portuguese Association for Certification (APCER); and the Regional Innovation Council of *S3 NORTE*, representing the Agro-Environmental Systems and Food platform.

March, 2025